

词汇: *work tasks* 工作任务

- 1 Is your house at its tidiest when you've got a **deadline** coming up? Do you have a list of jobs that you really need to do, but you really don't want to start doing? Procrastination can mean that we spend more time **putting off** a job than we'd ever actually spend completing it. Understanding why we do it might help us to understand how to stop doing it.
- 2 There are different reasons why people procrastinate. Some people **avoid** tasks if they can relate them to traumatic situations in their past. Sometimes we don't do certain tasks because we're **swamped** with other things. If people are unhappy about being asked to do something, they might put it off to feel like they are **regaining** some control. Another common reason for procrastination is just the worry that doing something will be unpleasant or that we will not be able to do it well enough to satisfy ourselves.
- 3 This last kind of procrastination can be a result of our **mindset**. People with a **perfectionist** mindset are likely to have a very **rigid** idea of what success in a task looks like. This is coupled with being anxious not to fail at that task. Psychology lecturer Annemiecke Apergis-Schoute points out that procrastination can be the result of a struggle between our brain's reward and threat systems. If the **threat** of failure or **discomfort** is greater than the potential reward from doing the task, we're likely to avoid it.
- 4 **Cognitive flexibility** could help us to avoid procrastinating. If we change the way that we think about a task, it can be easier to start working on it. If we can challenge our expectation of what succeeding could be, and how uncomfortable working on the task will be, it can seem less **threatening**. **Breaking down** tasks into small **components** also makes them less **daunting** as well as providing a feeling of achievement when each of these steps is completed. It can also be useful to consider what **triggers** procrastination for you. Having a better understanding of this can help you get things done.

测验与练习

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 _____

Paragraph 2 _____

Paragraph 3 _____

Paragraph 4 _____

- a. Why we avoid doing things
- b. Time management
- c. When it feels too hard to start working
- d. Think differently
- e. The need to be perfect

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. Tidying is a good way to avoid procrastinating.

- a. True
- b. False
- c. Not given

2. Procrastination can be a way that people use to take back _____.

- a. rewards
- b. control
- c. time

3. Procrastination can make people's time management worse.

- a. True
- b. False
- c. Not given

4. What does 'it' refer to in this sentence. *If the threat of failure or discomfort is greater than the potential reward from doing the task, we're likely to avoid it.*

- a. failure
- b. discomfort
- c. a task

5. Splitting tasks up makes them less threatening.

- a. True
- b. False
- c. Not given

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

You might find yourself often **1)** _____ the tasks that you need to do. Sometimes people procrastinate because they feel like they are **2)** _____ with important tasks. Sometimes, tasks can seem **3)** _____. This can often be the case if you are a bit of a **4)** _____. It can help to develop a more flexible **5)** _____ in order to see your tasks in a different way.

perfectionist	rigid	threatening
putting off		mindset
swamped		deadline

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

deadline	截止日期
put off	推迟
avoid	逃避
swamped	忙得不可开交
regain	重新获得
mindset	心态
perfectionist	完美主义者
rigid	僵化的
threat	威胁
discomfort	不适
cognitive flexibility	认知灵活性
threatening	有威胁的
break down	拆分，细分
component	组成部分
daunting	令人生畏的
trigger	引发

答案

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 **c) When it feels too hard to start working**

Paragraph 2 **a) Why we avoid doing things**

Paragraph 3 **e) The need to be perfect**

Paragraph 4 **d) Think differently**

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **a. False.** *Is your house at its tidiest when you've got a deadline coming up? Do you have a list of jobs that you really need to do, but you really don't want to start doing? Procrastination can mean that we spend more time putting off a job than we'd ever actually spend completing it.*

2. **b.** *If people are unhappy about being asked to do something, they might put it off to feel like they are **regaining some control**.*

3. **c. Not given.** The article doesn't mention time management.

4. **c.** 'It' in the sentence refers to the tasks that people are likely to avoid.

5. **a. True.** *Breaking down tasks into small components also makes **them less daunting** as well as providing a feeling of achievement when each of these steps are completed.*

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

You might find yourself often **putting off** the tasks that you need to do. Sometimes people procrastinate because they feel like they are **swamped** with important tasks. Sometimes, tasks can seem **threatening**. This can often be the case if you are a bit of a **perfectionist**. It can help to develop a more flexible **mindset** in order to see your tasks in a different way.